

June 2012.

He also shared that the Foundation board's would meet via conference call in late July to discuss its involvement in SPJ elections and the potential history book project.

He shared that the Foundation's assets are hovering around \$10M.

INTERNATIONAL CHAPTERS

Skeel shared via memo (Appendix B) that SPJ has seen increasing interest from international journalists. Although the organization has always allowed individuals to join regardless of geographic location, journalists abroad are now showing interest in starting SPJ chapters.

Skeel recommended that the Society be proactive in developing a plan for international chapter growth. The idea isn't to create a marketing strategy for growth, but to be prepared when requests come from outside the U.S.

In the memo, Skeel shared his research into international chapters and how they might impact the Society's operations. He shared findings from SPJ's counsel and other organizations that have an international presence. Furthermore, the memo detailed steps for accepting international chapters into SPJ, including but not limited to issues related to governance, awards, LDF and tax implications. Skeel concluded that SPJ could support international chapters, if the Society deemed the proposition worthy.

One of the key points of discussion centered around "vetting" international chapters. Some members of the executive committee were uncomfortable with the notion of SPJ deciding who was and who wasn't "worthy" of joining the Society. "It's a slippery slope considering we don't do that for our U.S. chapters."

Limor shared that the idea of international growth goes beyond just journalism. "It's about spreading our missions and democracy."

Upon proper motion and second by Limor and McCloskey, respectively, the committee voted to instruct Skeel to move forward with creating plan for international chapter growth based on the blueprint in the memo.

Skeel will deliver a final plan to the full board in September for its consideration.

In addition, Skeel was instructed to survey the Society's international members to find out why they value SPJ and why they have decided to join.

In addition to the discussion on chapter growth, Ensslin read a memo from International Journalism Committee chairman Ricardo Sandoval regarding recruitment of individual international members.

Recommendations from Sandoval's report were:

— Because we do not now "vet" international journalists — that is hold them to different standards than US journalists — in this new drive we should first reach out and invite a select first generation of international journalists based on recommendations from SPJ leadership and members of the international committee. The idea behind this is to set at least a reputational standard for future foreign journalists seeking to join SPJ's ranks. In short, we would select and invite the best journalists we know abroad and thus set them up as examples of the kind of journalist we seek as SPJ members.

— Prior to inviting this first crop of potential members, we ought to informally review them. For potential new members who we personally know, there would not be much actual vetting necessary. For other potential new members, I believe that our international committee and SPJ leadership have the global connections necessary to conduct some informal vetting of journalists from a number of regions.

— Subsequent potential new members who seek us out via traditional membership applications should be